

Animal Bite - Male (Adult)

Algorithm 1009 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- Animal or human bite wound assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant, immunocompromised, diabetic, or anticoagulated, what animal/person caused the bite, where is it, and where/when did exposure occur? Include rabies/tetanus history and safeguarding concerns.
2. [DURATION] When did the bite happen?
3. [YES_NO] Has the caller had a tetanus vaccine within the last 10 years?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Insect Bite

Was this an insect bite rather than a mammal or human bite or an insect sting?

A non-sting insect bite requires the authored Insect Bite pathway.

2. Redirect → Bee or Yellow Jacket Sting

Was this a bee, wasp, or yellow-jacket sting rather than a mammal or human bite?

A bee, wasp, or yellow-jacket sting requires the authored Bee or Yellow Jacket Sting pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is the wound large or deep, or is bleeding not stopping with direct pressure?

NHS.UK animal and human bites guidance lists a large or deep wound, or bleeding that cannot be stopped, as emergency ambulance or Emergency Department criteria.

1. Disposition level 70

Might there be debris such as teeth, hair, or dirt in the wound; is it hot, swollen, or leaking fluid; is there fever or chills; does it smell unpleasant; is it on the hands, feet, face, or head; was it a human bite; or has the caller not had a tetanus vaccine in the last 10 years?

NHS.UK guidance lists these as reasons to seek urgent clinical review for same-day assessment rather than manage entirely at home.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a minor, shallow bite with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes most bites as not serious and manageable at home with basic first aid.

Advice

Qatar emergency bite response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for uncontrolled bleeding, major tissue injury, face/neck airway threat, shock, reduced consciousness, or a dangerous animal/ongoing threat. Apply continuous direct pressure with a clean dressing unless an object is embedded. Move to safety without attempting to capture the animal. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: bleeding will not stop; pale, cold, faint, confused, or unresponsive person; airway, face, hand, genital, tendon, nerve, or major-joint injury.

Urgent bite wound review

- Clean the wound with soap and warm water, cover with a clean dressing, and arrange same-day medical review for possible antibiotics or tetanus assessment.
- Call Back If: increasing redness or swelling; fever develops.

First aid while arranging bite assessment

- Wash the wound thoroughly with soap and running water, pat dry, and cover with a clean dressing; do not squeeze or deliberately make it bleed. Human/animal species, location, depth, rabies exposure, tetanus status, antibiotic need, immunocompromise, pregnancy, and medication choice require prompt in-person assessment under the approved Qatar pathway.
- Call Back If: increasing warmth, swelling, redness, pain, pus, red streaks, or fever; loss of movement/feeling or worsening general condition.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive for uncontrolled bleeding, major tissue injury, face/neck airway threat, shock, reduced consciousness, or a dangerous animal/ongoing threat. Apply

continuous direct pressure with a clean dressing unless an object is embedded. Move to safety without attempting to capture the animal. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Animal and human bites", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/animal-and-human-bites/> (page last reviewed 27 October 2025)

Provenance

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